TLP:CLEAR

MSSQL Brute-force Farm + RDP Bruteforcer

Managed bulletproof VPS farm with centralised C2 panel — zerolimit-servers.cool / AS205997

MSSQL Brute-force • RDP Bruteforce • Bulletproof Hosting • C2 Panel

Parameter	Value
Analysis date	May 27, 2026
Classification	Credential Access / Brute-force Infrastructure
Threat level	HIGH
C2 panel	194.113.39.2:8443 — TLS O=MSSQL Panel (globally unique cert)
Farm size	10 MSSQL bots (194.113.39.0/24) + 5 RDP bots (185.218.138.0/24)
Operator	Vlad Cojuhari — zerolimit-servers.cool — AS205997
Announced via	AS206378 (FOP Dmytro Nedilskyi, UA/PL)
Upstream	AS202425 IP Volume inc. (bulletproof)
Active since	April 22, 2026 (earliest OTX pulse)

1. Executive Summary

A coordinated brute-force farm operating from the 194.113.39.0/24 subnet was identified targeting MSSQL servers (TCP/1433) globally. The infrastructure consists of exactly 10 Windows VPS nodes deployed with a uniform profile (RDP, SMB, WinRM, OpenSSH for Windows) and a centralised web control panel at 194.113.39.2:8443 bearing a self-signed TLS certificate with Subject O=MSSQL Panel — the only instance of this certificate observable across the entire internet at the time of analysis.

The farm is operated by Vlad Cojuhari (Moldova/Ukraine), who owns AS205997 (zerolimit-servers.cool, registered December 2025). The subnet is announced via AS206378 (FOP Dmytro Nedilskyi, Ukraine/Warsaw) and reaches the internet through AS202425 (IP Volume inc.), a known bulletproof upstream. The RIPE abuse contact for the network is ban-me-please@zerolimit-servers.cool — an explicit indicator of the operator's intent to ignore abuse reports.

A related subnet 185.218.138.0/24 (also AS205997) hosts five additional nodes running an "Ultimate RDP bruteforcer" panel on port 9090. The same bruteforcer tool was identified on two externally-operated hosts: 80.66.66.68 (AS209702, Bulgaria) and 109.205.211.4 (AS201814 Mevspace, Poland), suggesting the tool is being sold or shared beyond the primary operator.

2. Infrastructure

2.1. MSSQL farm — 194.113.39.0/24

Ten hosts at regular 4-address intervals (.2/.6/.10/.14/.18/.22/.26/.30/.34/.38). All run Windows with OpenSSH for Windows, RDP (3389), SMB (445), WinRM (5985/47001), and RPC (135). Node .2 additionally exposes the MSSQL Panel on port 8443.

IP	Open ports	Role
194.113.39.2	22, 135, 445, 3389, 5985, 8443	C2 panel + bot
194.113.39.6	22, 135, 445, 3389, 5985, 47001	Bot
194.113.39.10	22, 3389	Bot
194.113.39.14	22, 135, 139, 445, 3389, 5985	Bot
194.113.39.18	22, 135, 445, 3389, 5985	Bot
194.113.39.22	22, 135, 445, 3389, 5985	Bot
194.113.39.26	22, 135, 445, 3389, 5985	Bot
194.113.39.30	22, 3389	Bot
194.113.39.34	22, 135, 445, 3389, 5985	Bot
194.113.39.38	22, 135, 445, 3389, 5985	Bot

All RDP services share JARM 14d14d16d14d14d08c14d14d14d14dfd9c9d14e4f4f67f94f0359f8b28f532 and JA3S ba1b42efc7dc57bb43bf81de59791c1b — consistent with default Windows Server RDP without domain membership. SSH host keys are unique per node (scripted provisioning), all returning HASSH 671c5858369db8e0a60108d866bbf8ec (default OpenSSH for Windows — not a unique indicator on its own).

2.2. C2 Panel — 194.113.39.2:8443

The panel presents HTTP 401 Unauthorized with header WWW-Authenticate: Basic realm="MSSQL Panel". The TLS certificate is self-signed with Subject/Issuer O=MSSQL Panel, Serial=1, issued 2026-05-16 (infrastructure deployed 11 days before analysis). HTTP response headers (Go-style X-Content-Type-Options: nosniff, plain text body, ECDSA P-256 key, TLS 1.3) are consistent with a custom Go HTTP server.

Parameter	Value
TLS SHA-256	**fb3aa028387ecc371879ac10e123064050e766e6174fe4d1ddd1011db15e131a**
TLS SHA-1	**4b95c5c18abbc3b3b5885ab9576d7524d9e0f3b7**
JARM	**40d40d40d00000000043d43d00043d6aff5ab0f4fc31897186312c9e639319**
JA3S	**b210411e648f206db393c31561686aea**
Issued	**2026-05-16 13:52:36 UTC**

A global Shodan search for ssl:"MSSQL Panel" returns exactly one result — 194.113.39.2. The certificate is unique to this infrastructure. The same search on the operator's adjacent subnet 185.218.138.0/24 returns zero results, confirming this panel serves only the 194.113.39.0/24 farm.

2.3. RDP bruteforcer — 185.218.138.0/24

Five Windows hosts on the operator's directly-owned AS205997 subnet run an "Ultimate RDP bruteforcer" panel on port 9090 (HTTP 200, title "Ultimate RDP bruteforcer", Last-Modified: 2026-05-08). The panel body hash (SHA-256: 9d7f1c8b83f2b1a0029e71a007220bdc2f3fdc66b7433464114045e6963309f7) was found on 7 hosts globally at the time of analysis.

IP	ASN	Operator	Country
185.218.138.3	AS205997	Vlad Cojuhari	UA
185.218.138.5	AS205997	Vlad Cojuhari	UA
185.218.138.16	AS205997	Vlad Cojuhari	UA
185.218.138.17	AS205997	Vlad Cojuhari	UA
185.218.138.29	AS205997	Vlad Cojuhari	UA
80.66.66.68	AS209702	SOLDATOV-AS (Soldatov Alexey Valerevich)	BG
109.205.211.4	AS201814	Mevspace sp. z o.o.	PL

3. Operator Attribution

RIPE WHOIS for 194.113.39.0/24 (ORG-ZA297-RIPE) identifies the registrant as Vlad Cojuhari, Constantin Brancusi St 3, Moldova. The network was created 2026-01-30, placing it among the newest allocations in this ASN cluster. IPinfo confirms AS205997 website zerolimit-servers.cool, type Hosting, allocated 2025-12-09.

AS206378 (STOLITOMSON-AS, FOP Dmytro Nedilskyi, Ukraine) announces 194.113.39.0/24. Nedilskyi is also linked to AS211736 (31.43.160.0/19), which appears in CleanTalk spam blocklists — consistent with a history of announcing abuse-friendly prefixes.

AS202425 (IP Volume inc.) is the BGP upstream. IP Volume is widely documented as a bulletproof provider operating as a successor to Ecatel/Quasi Networks.

The domain zerolimit-servers.cool is fronted by Cloudflare CDN. Its mail infrastructure (mail.zerolimit-servers.cool) resolves to 194.38.20.97 (AS48693 Rices, UA) — the same AS that peers directly with AS205997. The mail server co-hosts numerous unrelated domains consistent with a shared spam or phishing mail platform.

4. MITRE ATT&CK Mapping

Tactic	Technique	ID	Evidence
Resource Development	Acquire Infrastructure: Server	T1583.003	10 bulletproof VPS under AS206378/AS205997
Resource Development	Acquire Infrastructure: Botnet	T1583.005	Coordinated farm + centralised panel
Credential Access	Brute Force: Password Guessing	T1110.001	MSSQL (1433) brute-force, global targets
Reconnaissance	Active Scanning: Scanning IP Blocks	T1595.001	OTX "Port Scanning Hosts" pulses from all nodes
Reconnaissance	Active Scanning: Service Scanning	T1595.002	Identifying open MSSQL 1433 targets
Command and Control	Application Layer Protocol: Web	T1071.001	Custom HTTPS panel at :8443 with Basic auth

5. Indicators of Compromise

Type	Value	Context	Confidence
IP	194.113.39.2	C2 panel + bot	High
IP	194.113.39.6 / .10 / .14 / .18	MSSQL bots	High
IP	194.113.39.22 / .26 / .30 / .34 / .38	MSSQL bots	High
Subnet	194.113.39.0/24	MSSQL farm (AS206378)	High
Subnet	185.218.138.0/24	RDP farm + mail infra (AS205997)	Medium
TLS SHA256	fb3aa028387ecc371879ac10e123064050e766e6174fe4d1ddd1011db15e131a	MSSQL Panel cert	High
JARM	40d40d40d00000000043d43d00043d	Panel :8443	Medium

	6aff5ab0f4fc31897186312c9e639319		
Domain	zerolimit-servers.cool	Operator brand / ASN website	High
IP	194.38.20.97	zerolimit mail origin (AS48693)	Medium
ASN	AS205997 (Vlad Cojuhari)	Operator's own ASN	High
ASN	AS206378 (FOP Dmytro Nedilskyi)	194.113.39.0/24 announcer	High
Email	ban-me-please@zerolimit-servers.cool	RIPE abuse contact (red flag)	High

6. Recommendations

6.1. Immediate blocking

- Block 194.113.39.0/24 on all perimeters, especially ingress to MSSQL/1433, RDP/3389, and SMB/445.
- Add 185.218.138.0/24 and 185.136.15.0/24 (same operator, AS205997) to a watchlist; block proactively if MSSQL/RDP exposure exists.
- Monitor or block mail from zerolimit-servers.cool and 194.38.20.97.

6.2. Detection

- Hunt on TLS: ssl.cert.subject.O="MSSQL Panel" in Shodan/Censys to detect new panel instances if the operator rotates IPs.
- Correlate new /24 prefixes in AS205997 / AS206378 with Windows RDP JARM 14d14d16... and uniform 4-address node spacing.
- MSSQL event ID 18456 (Login failed) spike from 194.113.39.0/24 — Sigma rule provided in the appendix.

6.3. Long-term

- Submit RIPE abuse reports against AS206378 and AS205997; escalate through upstream AS202425 (IP Volume) — the zerolimit abuse address is by design unresponsive.
- Disable MSSQL password authentication where possible; enforce certificate-based or Windows-integrated authentication.

Appendix — Sigma Rule

title: MSSQL brute-force from 194.113.39.0/24 logsource: { product: mssql, service: errorlog } detection: sel: { EventID: 18456 }   src: { ClientIP|cidr: "194.113.39.0/24" }   condition: sel and src level: high

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